Beyond bilateral issues, the two states are now much more in sync on larger regional issues. The “US-India Joint Strategic Vision for Asia-Pacific and the Indian Ocean” articulated by Obama and Modi in 2015 is the first comprehensive enunciation of a collaborative approach to regional security issues. The statement highlighted the fact that cooperation between the two largest democracies in the Indo-Pacific is “indispensable to promoting peace, prosperity and stability.” That the concurrent tensions in the South China Sea found an emphatic resonance in the document indicates that a convergence of interests and strategies to manage China’s increasing assertiveness in the region is now in the offing. In a veiled warning to China, the document clearly stated that “regional prosperity depends on security. We (India and the United States) affirm the importance of safeguarding maritime security and ensuring freedom of navigation and over flight throughout the region, especially in the South China Sea.” The two countries also indicated their preference for negotiated solutions to territorial and maritime disputes in the region, calling upon all stakeholders to “avoid the threat or use of force and pursue resolution of territorial and maritime disputes through all peaceful means, in accordance with universally recognised principles of international law, including the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea.”[32] As the first instance of India and the United States issuing a joint vision on the Indo-Pacific, it underscored that the concerns of the region have attained special relevance in Indo–US bilateral relationship.

If Modi could argue that India and the United States have overcome “the hesitations of history” under the Obama Administration, he has also been effortlessly wooing the Trump Administration by suggesting that “the convergence of my vision for ‘New India’ and President Trump’s vision for making America great again will add new dimensions to our